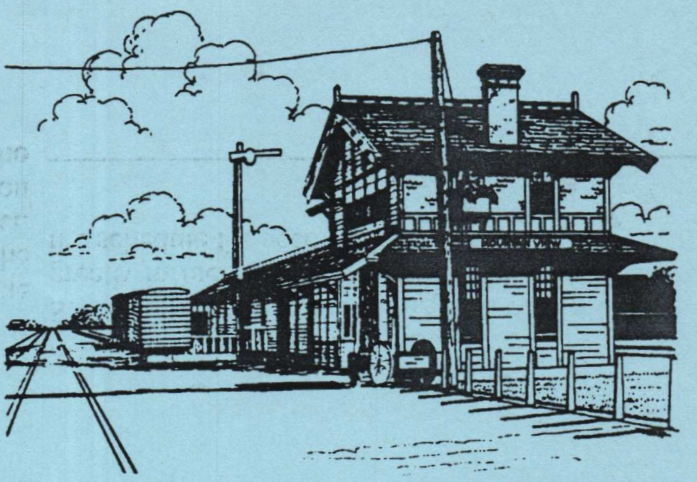
# Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

## Local Boy Makes Good
## Victor Calvo's Own Story
## The May Meeting

Victor Calvo will tell the story of growing up in Mountain View - *Local Boy Makes Good*. His story will begin with his ancestor's emigration to California via Hawaii, his early years in a hard working, successful farming family, culminating in a fruitful career in local and state politics as Assemblyman and Member of the State Public Utilities Commission.

Victor's early years were full, working on his father's farm and obtaining a good education in Mountain View schools. He is a 1942 graduate of Mountain View Union High School and after service in World War II obtained an AB degree in Political Science from Stanford University. From 1943-1945 he saw combat as a B24 pilot. Post war he established a successful local area business, served on the Mountain View Planning Commission and served two terms on the City Council, of which three years were as Mayor. At the county level he was on the Board of Supervisors for District 5. Subsequently he served in the California Assembly for the 21st district. He was appointed to the Public Utilities Commission by then Governor Brown. Truly a "local boy who made good."

After the presentation, there will be our usual opportunity for coffee and cookies and good fellowship. Please join with us at *The Adobe Building*, Sunday, May 4, 2003 at 2:00 P.M.

## Plans for the City
## The February Meeting

At the February 2, 2003 meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association, Margaret Nakamura Cooper presented a copy of the autobiography of her 100 year old mother, Nellie Yae Samiye Nakamura, a remarkable review of one hundred years of local history. The book is available to inspect at the Mountain View Public Library History Center.

Mountain View's City Manager, Kevin C. Duggan, gave a presentation about the City's plans for the future, with particular emphasis on the Senior Center and the Community Center. The National, State and Local financial prospects will of course greatly influence just how much can be done and the schedule for accomplishing it.

# In Commemoration

***William Charles Garliepp:*** Born in Mountain View January 20, 1921, died February 11, 2003 at his home in Oxnard. He was the oldest grandson of William Martin Garliepp, one of the signers of the original petition to incorporate the town of Mountain View. William, more commonly known as "Bill," was the son of William Louis and Nellie Ella Garliepp and was born in their home on Bryant Street in Mountain View. He attended local schools with many of his 22 cousins, and graduated from Mountain View High School in 1938. Bill then joined the Navy before his 18th birthday, finishing his stint with the Navy in three years. He signed on to the Military Sea Transport Group where he served until retirement. His work moved him around from Seattle, Washington to Virginia, Florida and finally to Oxnard, CA where he retired. Bill's wife Louise, predeceased him and leaves his son Bill, Jr.,living in Southern California. He also leaves a sister, Margaret Sideroff of San Rafael, CA and two brothers, Ken of Marina, CA and Jon of Cupertino, CA. William Garliepp was a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

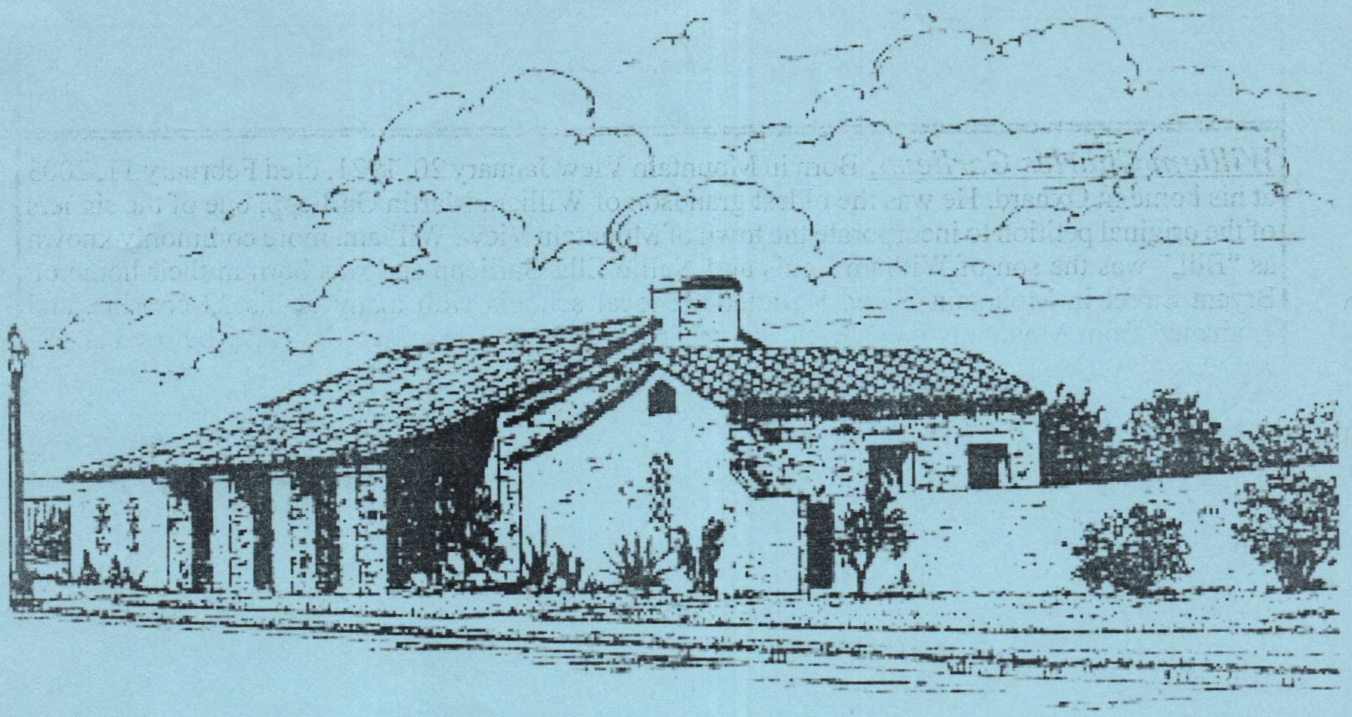
***Laura Dale Gentry:*** Born in Mountain View March, 1916, died in Fresno February, 2003. Laura was the youngest of four children of James Jackson Dale, Sr. and Eleanor (Custer) Dale. Siblings were James Jackson Dale Jr., Dorothy and Claire.

Laura was a great granddaughter of Edward Dale who came to this area by 1850 and was one of the founding members, with his wife Elizabeth, of the earliest protestant church here, Cumberland Presbyterian, now the First Presbyterian Church of Mountain View.

Laura graduated from Mountain View Union High School in 1934 and married Ellis Anderson, Jr., a 1925 graduate of MVUHS. They had two children, Donald Dale Anderson, born 1941 and Stanley Anderson, born 1945. Laura later married Lawrence Gentry, a Los Altos Architect. Laura was a Life Member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

***Doris Mary Ebere:*** Died February 10, 2003 in Mountain View. Daughter of the late Chester F. Awalt. Beloved mother of Gary Ebere and wife Betty of Mountain View, Judy Ludlow and husband Terry of Livermore. Grandmother of Maureen Martin, Cathy Etheridge, Vicki Ebere and Lori Ludlow. Sister of Patricia Reyburn and the late Robert Awalt.

Born March 14, 1911 in Santa Cruz and moved to Mountain View when she was one year old. Graduated from Mountain View High School in 1928. Met her future husband Gilbert (Bud) Ebere and they were married in 1936. An active member of the Miramonte Chapter #141 of Eastern Star for 73 years and a Life Member of the Mountain View Historical Association.



## President's Message From Craig Holden

Here is an update on what is happening behind the scenes between membership meetings of our MVHA.

The by-laws revision is nearing completion and should be ready for a vote of the membership by the November meeting.

We are working on a new multi functional membership application that will serve as a contact medium for our association. The new application will feature our "Milestones" book, will facilitate ordering the book by mail and will serve as the application for membership.

In general, we are working at organizational machinery to improve the operation of our organization. Work on a handbook to give direction and continuity for officers and standing committee chairpersons is progressing.

We plan to sell our "Milestones" book at upcoming street=fair functions in Mountain View. Hip Telmont is our able chairman in charge.

On August 3, we will gather for the MVHA's annual barbeque and raffle. The Barbeque Committee is in the capable hands of John Viscovich.

The final line here is **VOLUNTEER**, so be prepared to help.

*Craig Holden, President MVHA*

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## Old Newspaper Items Compiled By Barbara Kinchen

***100 Years Ago (1903):*** For sale at $150 an acre, 688 acres, part of the Ynigo Rancho. Situated on the Alviso and Jagel's Landing Road with 25 acres of sugar prunes and the rest in cultivation. There is a nine room house with bath, large barn with room for 24 horses, 50' X 100' barn that will hold 500 tons of hay, blacksmith shop, good buildings for hired help and 5 artesian wells ranging from 96 to 180 feet deep.

N.H. McCorkle has just opened a furniture store on

Castro Street. He also offers undertaking services.

J.J. Dale held dancing classes in Olympic Hall. Regular classes met twice a week for one month, for which men paid $3.50 and women $2.50. Private lessons were 50¢.

Miles of sweet peas bloomed on the San Francisco Road just west of Santa Clara. "They are planted in strips about 50' wide and are nearly a mile in length, each color to itself (white, scarlet, lavender, etc.). They resemble banners."

***75 Years Ago (1928):*** At Penneys in Palo Alto Lady-Lyke brand girdles were $1.98-$2.98 and "apron frocks to make housework a pleasure" sold for 49¢.

Mountain View Theatre announced that three great films would be coming soon: Harold Lloyd in Speedy, Old Ironsides with Wallace Beery and The Circus starring Charles Chaplin. In the same newspaper was a quote from Professor F.D. Tyson of Pittsburgh University: "Persons who enjoy the average moving picture have an intelligence of about12 years."

Dr. Richard T. Glyer has organized a community band of Mountain View and Sunnyvale musicians.

An arson fire destroyed St. Joseph's Catholic Church early in the morning of March 18th.

Playing at the Curran Theatre in San Francisco was *The Desert Song*, a romantic operetta featuring sheiks, dancing girls and French Foreign Legionnaires. Both Perry and Earl Askam, grandsons of Henry Rengstorff, were in the production, with Perry in the leading role of the Red Shadow.

Mr. Shiraki and Mr. S. Hori hosted a picnic for bay-area Japanese, most natives of the province of Fukuako, Japan. Approximately 2,000 enjoyed the contests, games and refreshments at the Abbott ranch, just across the highway (El Camino Real) from Mountain View Avenue.

***50 Years Ago (1953):*** All Chamber of Commerce members agreed to close their businesses on Good Friday from noon to 3 p.m.

Earl "Bud" Mockbee was chairman of the Easter Egg Hunt sponsored by Lions Club and City Recreation Department. Over 700 youngsters participated, the smaller ones at the Woman's Club, others across Castro at City Park.

Bank of America honored Miss Gertrude Lewis for her 30 years of service. In 1923 she started as a bookkeeper for Farmers and Merchants National Bank, at the corner of Castro and Villa Streets. In 1926 the bank became Bank of Italy and soon Bank of America. Miss Lewis is now in charge of statements and safe deposit boxes.

City Manager James Thomas predicted that income for 1953-54 would reach a new high of $700,000 and assessed valuation could go to $12 million.

Eighty-six year old William McCall left Mountain View on a Greyhound bus for New York. There he will board the superliner "United States" and sail to Scotland where he was born. He lives with his daughter and son-in-law, Mr. And Mrs Louis Beck when not off traveling.

After years of trying to persuade Southern Pacific to renovate or replace the 1888 train station, Council authorized City Building Inspector Milton Christiansen to post a formal notice condemning the building as a safety hazard.

***25 Years Ago (1978):*** Police raided a cock fight one afternoon, confiscating 39 roosters and spurs and spur holders. Of the 38 men present, only the owner of the Stierlin Road property where the event took place was arrested.

The State has turned down a request for funds to restore the Rengstorff House. It was estimated that $128,000 in private funds will now need to be raised.

A court suit was brought against the Seventh Day Adventist Church and the Church-owned Pacific Press Publishing Association regarding a pay scale favoring men over women employees. The Church claims exemption from civil laws for all of its religious institutions. A former secretary claims that any employee who has brought suit in the past has been fired.

With the passage of Proposition 13, Mountain View estimates a loss of $3.3 million in property taxes the

first year. Cost-cutting measures under consideration include: salary freeze, hiring freeze, elimination of capital improvements, positions and travel allowances, budget cuts for every department, turning off street lights and not offering summer recreation programs. Business licenses, construction taxes and higher real estate transfer taxes are being considered to increase revenue.

Dennis Mateo, Jr., was named Athlete of the Year by Palo Alto Times. The Mountain View High School senior is a three-sport star: football, baseball and basketball. In 1957, his father, Dennis Mateo, Sr., was all-star athlete in the same sports at the same school.

## New to the Mountain View History Center
## By Barbara Kinchen

***From Cindy Wolverton:*** A very, very worn, 57" x 80", City of Mountain View flag with the city seal on a blue background.

***From Margaret Nakamura Cooper:*** On behalf of the Nakamura family — the book, *"A Century of Change – The Memoirs of Nellie Yae Samiye Nakamura from 1902 – 2002."* Not only is this a wonderful tribute to the one-hundred-year-old mother of the family, it is a wealth of information about many locations and their residents, including the Los Altos and Mountain View area. Many photos are included of family and friends, including the Minton family.

***From Godfrey Baumgartner:*** Paper on "History of Mountain View and Sugar Beets" telling of the operation of the sugar beet shipping facilities by railroad cars to Alvarado. His father worked there, not far from the Baumgartner orchard. Also given was a sack in which beets from each load were set aside to be tested for sugar content, which would determine the price to be paid the grower.

***From George R. Holden:*** Contributed extracts from his memoirs about Mountain View's sugar beet "dump."

***From an Unknown Donor:*** Mountain View Union High School yearbooks for 1944, 1945, and 1946.

## Street Talk
## By Barbara Kinchen

The February *Street Talk* question was: In 1892 a 250 acre subdivision, called the *Miramonte Subdivision,* was put on the market with road names of Ada, Alice, Gladys, Louise and Stella, said to be named for members of the land owners. What was that family name?

Only Ada, Alice and Gladys exist today as reminders of John Sullivan (1824-1882), who bought over 400 acres of land from Maria Josefa Castro Davidson and her husband, Peter Davidson, in 1853. The property ran northerly from our present El Camino Real to Moffett Field and was adjoining the Murphy lands. Sullivan came to California in the Townsend - Stevens - Murphy overland party in 1844. He was founder of San Francisco's Hibernia Bank, a generous donor to his Catholic church, including land for the original St. Mary's Church in San Francisco and in 1868, land on El Camino Real in Old Mountain View for the first St. Joseph's Church.

***New Question:*** Can you guess what the missing letters are in the following statement? In 1906 there were so many new houses on Mountain View Avenue occupied by young newly-married couples that it was called "H _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _" Avenue.

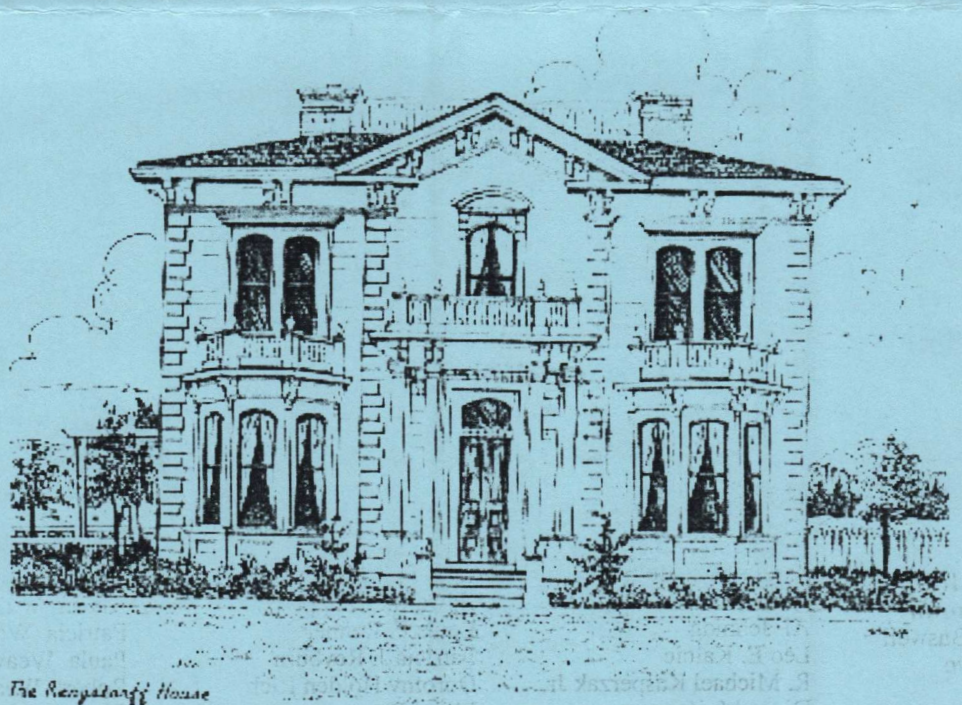
## A Modest Request From Your Editor

A grandson (William Garleipp) of one of the signers of the original petition to incorporate the Town of Mountain View died recently. Do any of our readers know of other direct descendants of signers of that document still living in the area? Let us know about them.

## Lena Alameda Celebrates Her 105th Birthday

Lena Alameda celebrated her 105th birthday April 2, 2003, at a party held at the Milpitas Care Center, her present home. In attendance were many of her family and friends including Father Di Nardo, Villa Siena Chaplain and Father Oscar Tabujara of St. Joseph's Catholic Church.

Lena is a Special Member of the Mountain View Historical Association, a citizen of Mountain View for more than 85 years and a Native Daughter of the Golden West. The MVHA recognized her birthday by the presentation of a beautiful orchid plant.



The Rengstorff House

## Membership Report
## June Casey

Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $ 10.00 per year for a family membership. Life memberships are available for $100.00 per person.

| | |
|---|---|
| Life Members | 104 |
| Special Member | 1 |
| Honored Member | 1 |
| Annual Memberships | 253 |
| Total Memberships | 359 |

New Life Members
Dorothy Holden Rich

New Annual Members
David Haywood
Patrick Starr

## Association Officers And Executive Committee

| | |
|---|---|
| President | Craig Holden |
| Past President & Social | Ralph Faravelli |
| Vice President | Pat Figueroa |
| Sergeant At Arms | John Viscovich |
| Secretary | Margaret Peterson |
| Editor | Hilton Brown |
| Membership | June Casey |
| Programs and Publicity | Wally Erichsen |
| Hospitality | Elizabeth Engberg |
| Memorial/Remembrance | Edna Thompson |
| Ways & Means | Hip Telmont |
| Historical Data | Barbara Kinchen |
| Amplification/Recording | Albert Jehning |

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting.

## Life, Honored and Special Members

*Honored Member*

Chris Castro

*Special Member*

Lena Alameda

*Life Members*

O. Lennart Ahlkvist
Mario Ambra
J. Paul Arata
May E. Armanini
John Arrillaga
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Robert J. Bonetti
Flora T. Brown
Hilton U. Brown, III
Laura Withrow Brown
Mary Ann Meek Buswell
Alice Churin Carvo
June Casey
William A. Dale
June Redwine de Larios
Cliff Del Carlo
Joseph Diaz
Kevin C. Duggan
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace J. Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Tom Frankum
Janice Mae Frankum
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Edward Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
John L. Hirshbek
Norene Hogle
Audrey Jarvis Hoke
Craig Holden
Marjorie Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
Harold Jarvis
Al Jehning
Leo E. Kalcic
R. Michael Kasperzak Jr.
Diane M. Keenan
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Barbara Krzyczkowska
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargin Malovos
Thomas E. Miller
Frances Churin Mills
Eva Mockbee
Betty C. Monroe
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Don Newfarmer
Anne G. Nichols
Nancy Noe
Matt Pear
Richard J. Peery
Harry Pinto
Ida Pinto
Milan Popovich
Massimo Prati
John P. Puppo
Edward L. Puppo
Louis F. Renner
Patricia J. Reyburn
Dorothy Holden Rich
Mark Rogge
Vivian Schatz
Robert C. Schick
Jamil Shaikh
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Margaret Garliepp Sideroff
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Jim Spangler
Martin J. Spangler
Austin Spencer
Honor Spitz
Brigitte Stafford
J. R. Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Jane Culver Stoecklin
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Sally Moore Taboada
H. (Hip) A. Telmont
Charles Thompson
Edna Thompson
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Paula Weaver
Robert Weaver
Denise Williams
Bill Wissel
Lorraine A. Wormald
Mary Lou Zoglin

# MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
## *REGULAR MEETING*

*"LOCAL BOY MAKES GOOD"*
HEADLINE FOR THE NEXT
MVHA MEETING
*PRESENTING*
*VICTOR CALVO*

SUNDAY, MAY 4, 2003
2:00 P.M.

THE ADOBE BUILDING
MOFFETT BLVD AND
CENTRAL EXPRESSWAY

**MEMBERSHIP:** Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

**AIMS:** The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

### MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

*TYPE:* NEW____ RENEWAL____

Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

*Make Check Payable to:*
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

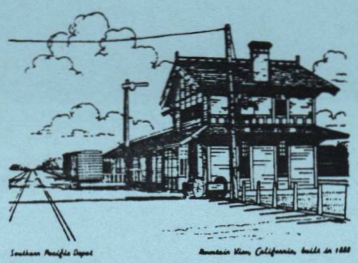
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P.O. BOX 252
MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

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